

Facial expressions

We constantly use facial expressions during conversation. As speakers, we raise eyebrows to emphasize a point or indicate a question, and as listeners, we use expressions to show interest in what is being said. One study looked at the top reasons for using facial expressions in conversation.

KEY

- Speaker
- Both
- Listener



FACIAL SHRUG



THINKING



EMPHASIS



EMPATHIC



QUESTION



RETELLING



PERSONAL REACTION



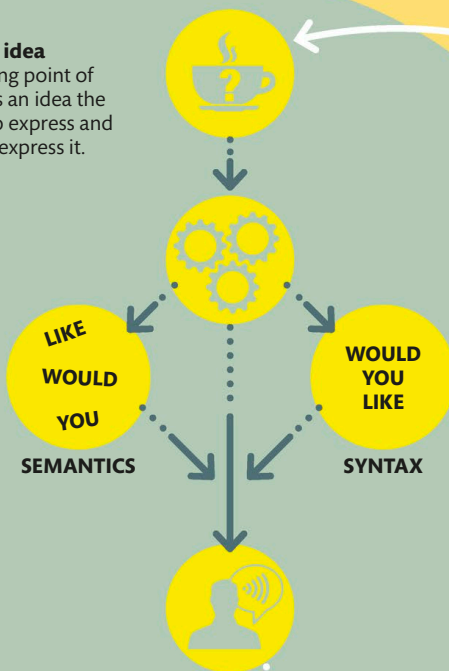
I'M LISTENING

THE SPEAKER

- 1 Message idea**
The starting point of a conversation is an idea the speaker wants to express and the intention to express it.

- 2 Formulation**
The speaker selects the words with the right meaning (semantics) and then puts them into the right form and order (syntax) to make sense. For example, "Would you like a drink?" is a question; "You would like a drink" is a statement; and "Like you drink a would" is nonsense. Broca's area (see p.126) is crucial to these two processes.

- 3 Articulation**
To say the message, the speaker moves the mouth, tongue, lips, and throat, controlled by the motor cortex, to form the speech sounds with the right intonation.



NO,
THANKS

TURN TAKING

GARDEN PATH SENTENCES

We can be misled if the first part of a message suggests an idea that is contradicted by the later part. For example: "The car stopped at the crash scene was soon surrounded by police." We initially understand "stopped" to mean something the car did; but when we hear "was soon," it becomes clear that the car was stopped by police. We have to revisit the start of the message to make sense of it. This type of statement is called a garden path sentence.

WOULD
YOU LIKE
A DRINK?